

Daniel Thornton

Head of Business Development – Financial Services

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Head of Business Development specialising in financial services with 13 years building revenue-generating partnerships between fintech innovators and traditional financial institutions. Deep network across banking, insurance, capital markets, and wealth management. Expert in navigating complex compliance and procurement processes at regulated institutions to accelerate deal velocity.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Business Development – Financial Services

Sep 2019 – Present

Plaid, New York, NY

- Led financial services BD team of 10 covering US, Canada, and UK banking and wealth management markets
- Closed 35+ strategic bank partnerships including top-10 US banks, regional banks, and credit unions
- Drove \$55M in new ARR from financial institution partnerships over 4 years
- Negotiated data access and revenue-sharing framework with 5 of the 10 largest US banks
- Spearheaded regulatory engagement strategy with OCC and CFPB supporting open banking policy development

Director, Financial Institutions BD

Jun 2015 – Aug 2019

Marqeta, Oakland, CA

- Built card issuing partnership programme with 20+ banks and credit unions enabling \$2B in annual card spend
- Closed \$18M in annual processing revenue through strategic bank BIN sponsorship agreements
- Managed relationships with Mastercard and Visa network partners, securing preferential interchange rates
- Launched embedded finance pilot with 3 regional banks generating \$4M in Year 1 revenue

Senior Business Development Manager

Mar 2010 – May 2015

Green Dot Corporation, Pasadena, CA

- Established retail banking distribution partnerships with Walmart, Walgreens, and CVS Health
- Grew retail card distribution network from 25,000 to 65,000 POS locations over 5 years

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

\$55M Financial Institution ARR — Plaid's FS BD team delivered \$55M ARR in 4 years across bank partnerships

Top-10 Bank Agreements — Negotiated data-sharing framework with 5 of the 10 largest US banks

65K POS Locations — Grew Green Dot's retail network from 25K to 65K distribution points over 5 years

CORE SKILLS

Fintech/Finance	Open banking, Embedded finance, Card issuing, Payment processing, Wealth management
BD Skills	Bank partnership development, Regulatory negotiation, BIN sponsorship, Revenue sharing
Compliance	OCC, CFPB, PCI-DSS, AML/KYC, Bank Secrecy Act, State money transmitter licensing
Tools	Salesforce, Dealroom, PitchBook, Bloomberg Terminal, DocuSign CLM, Ironclad
Network	C-suite relationships at 50+ US/UK financial institutions and payment networks

EDUCATION

M.B.A., Finance

Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania

2007 – 2010

B.A. Economics

Princeton University

2003 – 2007

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- Certified Treasury Professional (CTP)
- Nacha Accredited ACH Professional (AAP)
- CISA – Certified Information Systems Auditor
- Anti-Money Laundering Specialist (CAMS)